

Post Graduate Grading Criteria for Dissertations

Criteria	100-90% (Exceptional-Distinction)	89-80% (Outstanding-Distinction)	79-70% (Excellent- Distinction)	69-60% (Merit)	59-50% (Pass)	49-40% (Marginal Fail)	39-30% (Fail)	29-20% (Fail)	19-0% (Fail)
Knowledge and understanding of the topic/ issues under consideration (20%)	An exceptional and systematic demonstration of knowledge and understanding, which displays originality and presents some challenges to the boundaries of academic schools of thought.	An outstanding demonstration of knowledge and understanding, displaying originality and an advanced understanding of the topic relevant to the work.	An excellent demonstration of knowledge and understanding, displaying some originality and in-depth understanding in all key areas of knowledge relevant to the work.	A very good demonstration of knowledge and understanding, displaying in-depth understanding in all key areas of knowledge relevant to the work.	A satisfactory demonstration of knowledge and understanding, displaying the required understanding in all key areas of knowledge relevant to the work.	A weak demonstration of knowledge and understanding, displaying limited understanding of some key areas of knowledge relevant to the work.	An unsatisfactory demonstration of knowledge and understanding, displaying very limited understanding of some key areas of knowledge relevant to the work.	A poor demonstration of knowledge and understanding, displaying very limited understanding across a substantial proportion of key areas of knowledge relevant to the work.	A very poor demonstration of knowledge and understanding, displaying no familiarity with the course material or work and irrelevant to the key areas of knowledge applicable to the work.
Knowledge and critical understanding of research methodology and appropriate implementation (20%)	Critically demonstrates exceptional knowledge, justification and understanding of suitable methodology, in relation to own research. Displays creativity in the application and implementation of methodology.	Critically demonstrates outstanding knowledge, justification and understanding of suitable methodology, in relation to own research. Displays evaluative judgement in the application and implementation of methodology.	Critically demonstrates excellent knowledge, justification and understanding of suitable methodology, in relation to own research. Displays analytical application and implementation of the methodology.	Demonstrates very good knowledge, justification and understanding of suitable methodology, in relation to own research. Mostly displays analytical application and implementation of the methodology, though with some weaknesses.	Demonstrates satisfactory knowledge, justification and understanding of suitable methodology, in relation to own research. Displays some analytical application and implementation of the methodology, though this is limited.	Demonstrates weak knowledge, justification and understanding of suitable methodology, in relation to own research. Limited display of analytical application and implementation of the methodology, with some errors.	Demonstrates unsatisfactory knowledge, justification and understanding of suitable methodology. Very limited display of analytical application and implementation of the methodology, with significant errors and/or omissions.	Demonstrates poor knowledge, justification and understanding of suitable methodology. Little to no display of analytical application and implementation of the methodology.	Demonstrates very poor, or no, knowledge, justification and understanding of suitable methodology. Little to no display of analytical application and implementation of the methodology.

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Criticality (20%)	An exceptional and comprehensive demonstration of independent critical analysis, thought and/or reflection, with regards to linking theory and practice where appropriate.	An outstanding demonstration of critical analysis, thought and/or reflection, with regards to linking theory and practice where appropriate.	An excellent demonstration of critical analysis, thought and/or reflection, with regards to linking theory and practice where appropriate.	A very good demonstration of critical analysis, thought and/or reflection, with regards to linking theory and practice where appropriate.	A satisfactory demonstration of critical analysis, thought and/or reflection, with regards to linking theory and practice where appropriate.	A weak demonstration of critical analysis, thought and/or reflection, with regards to linking theory and practice where appropriate.	An unsatisfactory demonstration of critical analysis, thought and/or reflection, with regards to linking theory and practice where appropriate.	A poor demonstration of critical analysis, thought and/or reflection, with regards to linking theory and practice where appropriate.	A very poor demonstration of critical analysis, thought and/or reflection, with no attempt to link theory and practice where appropriate.
Ethical considerations (15%)	Exceptional consideration of potential ethical issues associated with the assessment.	Outstanding consideration of potential ethical issues associated with the assessment.	Excellent consideration of potential ethical issues associated with the assessment.	Very good consideration of many potential ethical issues associated with the assessment.	Satisfactory consideration of most ethical issues associated with the assessment.	Weak consideration of potential ethical issues associated with the assessment.	Unsatisfactory consideration of ethical issues associated with the assessment.	Poor consideration of ethical issues associated with the assessment.	Very poor, or no, consideration of ethical issues associated with the assessment.
Use of relevant sources (10%)	Exceptional evidence of extensive reading/ use of source material (primary sources/ current research at the forefront of the field/ professional practice under consideration), accurately and convincingly in support of their work.	Outstanding evidence of extensive reading/ use of source material (primary sources/ current research), accurately in support of their work.	Excellent evidence of extensive reading/ use of source material (primary sources/ current research), accurately in support of their work.	Very good evidence of a wide range of reading/ use of source material (primary sources/ current research), broadly accurately in support of their work.	Satisfactory evidence of familiar or module reading/ use of source material (primary sources/ current research), adequately used, but with errors, omissions or questionable interpretations, in support of their work.	Weak evidence of familiar or module reading/ use of source material (primary sources/ current research), but with errors, omissions or questionable interpretations.	Unsatisfactory evidence of familiar or module reading / use of source material (mainly unreliable/ dated research), with major errors, omissions or misconceptions, in support of their work.	Poor evidence of reading/ use of source material, with very little evidence of reading and views presented are unsupported.	Very poor or no evidence of reading/ use of source material in support of their work and views are unsupported.

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Academic integrity (10%)	An exceptional demonstration of academic writing, including correct use of academic convention, citation and/or referencing. Work shows academic integrity of a professional or publishable standard, fully conforming with institutional guidance.	An outstanding demonstration of academic writing, including correct use of academic convention, citation and/or referencing. Work shows an accurate attempt working towards a professional or publishable standard, with no errors of conforming with institutional guidance.	An excellent demonstration of academic writing, including correct use of academic conventions, citation and/or referencing. Work shows an accurate attempt, which shows elements of working towards a professional or publishable standard, with a very few errors of conforming with institutional guidance.	A very good demonstration of academic writing, including correct use of academic conventions, citation and/or referencing with only minor omissions. Work shows broadly accurate attempt, but with the odd weaknesses of conforming with institutional guidance.	A satisfactory demonstration of academic writing, including some correct use of academic conventions, citation and/or referencing. Work shows satisfactory attempt, but with some weaknesses of conforming with institutional guidance.	A weak demonstration of academic writing, including incorrect use of academic conventions, citation and/or referencing. Work shows some attempt, but with significant weaknesses of conforming with institutional guidance.	An unsatisfactory demonstration of academic writing, including incorrect use of academic conventions, citation and/or referencing. Work shows a largely weak attempt of conforming with institutional guidance.	A poor demonstration of academic writing, including incorrect use of academic conventions, citation and/or referencing. Work shows very little attempt of conforming with institutional guidance.	A very poor demonstration of academic writing, including absent and/or incorrect use of academic conventions, citation and referencing. Work shows no attempt of conforming with institutional guidance.
Structure and Presentation (as detailed in the assessment guidance) (5%)	An exceptional structure and faultless presentation. Work is of a professional or publishable quality.	An outstanding structure and presentation, working towards a professional or publishable standard of work.	An excellent structure and presentation, which shows elements of presentation and structure at a professional or publishable standard.	A very good structure and presentation but may have some omissions against the guidelines.	A satisfactory structure and presentation that may not entirely follow the set guidelines.	Weakness in structure and presentation, that may not entirely follow the set guidelines.	Unsatisfactory structure and presentation that does not attempt to follow the set guidelines.	Poor structure and presentation that does not attempt to follow the set guidelines.	Very poor or incomplete structure and presentation that does not attempt to follow the set guidelines.

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Single-Point Rubric to describe full-mark expectations for each assessment criteria. **Please note these expectations should be read along with (in the context of) the assessment task guidance.**

Assessment Criteria	Description of Standard Expectation/Proficiency
Knowledge and understanding of the topic/ issues under consideration (20%)	Does your work show comprehensive insight and understanding of the topic, such as the aims and objectives of the report? Would this report stimulate constructive dialogue, commentary, or a new understanding among your audience?
Knowledge and critical understanding of research methodology and appropriate implementation (20%)	This refers to the description of your methodology and should include a clear rationale for your choice of approach and implementation.
Criticality (20%)	Have you clearly analysed and synthesised appropriate ideas/tasks/reading in this piece of work, creating a critical argument/discussion/evaluation of the topic? Have you provided a critical self-evaluation of your work?
Ethical considerations (15%)	Have you clearly reviewed the legal, social, ethical, and professional impact of your work, including the methodology?
Use of relevant sources (10%)	Have you provided evidence of extensive reading on the topic(s) through the quality of references used (not just the number of references), showing how each one supports your work? Have you used relevant source material in your development?
Academic integrity (10%)	Is there an accurate use of citations and references throughout this piece of work? Have you demonstrated the required integrity in your submission?
Structure and Presentation (as detailed in the assessment guidance) (5%)	Your work should be well-structured with minimal errors in spelling, grammar and punctuation. Have you met all the requirements provided in the guidance notes?